



FOUR-COURSE SYSTEM

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-00 Start Here

Exact route, tool-install timing, evidence folders and Gate unlock rules

Artifact	C3_00_START_HERE_BEGINNER_FIRST_RC1
Status	2026 - LEARNER EDITION
Teaching standard	M01 beginner-first teacher loop; book remains sufficient without video.
Bridge boundary	Course 2B competencies may be assumed; all new engineering concepts still start from first principles.
Brand	Charcoal #1F2937 Teal #14B8A6 Soft Blue #3B82F6 AMOLED #000

House rule: understand -> follow once -> see expected result -> break/fix -> do a changed version -> validate -> explain -> save evidence. A running command alone never counts as mastery.



Your exact C3-00 route

- 1. Read C3-006 Environment Setup only through the step needed for the current lesson. Do not install heavy later-course tools.
- 2. Open C3-010 at the exact lesson page. Follow the teacher walkthrough once.
- 3. Complete only the matching P01-P12 task in C3-011 and save it under an append-only attempt folder.
- 4. Open only the matching protected review section in C3-012 after the attempt is saved.
- 5. Close review, complete the changed retry, validate and explain back.
- 6. Mark lesson mastered only when changed retry + validation + evidence are complete.
- 7. After L01-L12, complete C3-013 Dataset Inspector Mini-Lab.
- 8. When all required lesson/Mini-Lab competencies pass, attempt Gate A independently.
- 9. Open Gate A review only after the Gate attempt is frozen. Repair only weak competencies.
- 10. Gate B/C stay protected unless explicitly assigned as fresh full retests.

APPEND-ONLY EVIDENCE RULE

```
evidence/  
  L01/attempt_001/  
  L01/retry_001/  
  L02/attempt_001/  
  ...  
  MINI_LAB/attempt_001/  
  GATE_A/attempt_001/
```

Never overwrite an earlier attempt to make it look cleaner. New work goes into a new attempt/retry folder. Your mistakes are part of the learning evidence.

WHAT NOT TO INSTALL YET

Do not install Airflow, Spark, Kafka, Delta/Fabric engineering runtimes or cloud CLIs in C3-00. Docker appears only at L11. This keeps the beginner environment small and debuggable.

C2B HANDOFF

Assume the Bridge exit evidence is valid for analytical SQL, Python automation, data modeling, warehousing/data quality, independent analysis, cloud/Fabric awareness and professional ownership. C3-00 activates engineering operation skills rather than repeating those subjects.

ZERO-CRITICAL-FAILURE POLICY

Gate PASS requires every required competency to pass and zero critical failures. There is no percentage/average shortcut. A critical failure cannot be averaged away by strong scores elsewhere.